

Aira Next — Frequently Asked Questions

Everything you need to know about applying, paying, and graduating from Aira Next. Last updated 14 March 2026. Contact admissions@airanext.id for anything not covered here.

About Aira Next

What is Aira Next?

Aira Next is a project-based AI engineering bootcamp based in Jakarta, Indonesia. We train software engineers to build, evaluate, and ship production AI systems — not just notebooks. Our flagship is a 16-week AI Engineering track. We also run shorter weekend workshops on specific topics like RAG, evals, and agentic workflows.

Who founded Aira Next?

Aira Next was founded in 2024 by Citra Pradana (ex-Gojek ML platform) and Daniel Surya (ex-Tokopedia data) after they noticed local AI hires kept arriving with strong notebook skills but weak production instincts. The school is registered in Jakarta as PT Aira Pendidikan Nusantara.

Where are you located?

Our studio is at Menara BCA, Level 22, Jl. M.H. Thamrin No.1, Jakarta Pusat. The program is hybrid — two in-person days per week at the studio, the rest asynchronous. Students outside Jakarta can attend the in-person days virtually via our co-working partner network in Bandung, Yogyakarta, and Surabaya.

Programs and Curriculum

What is the AI Engineering track?

The AI Engineering track is a 16-week, project-based, mentor-led program. You'll build a production-grade RAG system with a proper evaluation harness, ship agentic workflows that call real tools, and complete a capstone project shipped against a brief from one of our hiring partners. The capstone counts toward your portfolio when applying for roles.

How is the curriculum structured?

The 16 weeks are split into four phases:

Foundations (weeks 1–4): Python for AI engineering, prompt engineering, the LLM API surface (OpenAI, Anthropic, Qwen), embeddings, vector databases.

Build (weeks 5–9): Build a real RAG system end-to-end — ingestion pipeline, chunking strategy, hybrid retrieval (vector + BM25), reranking, grounded answer generation, citations.

Specialize (weeks 10–13): Pick one of three tracks — agentic workflows, evaluation and observability, or fine-tuning. Each track has its own mentor and project.

Capstone (weeks 14–16): Ship a complete project against a real brief from a hiring partner. Demo day on the last Friday of week 16.

What are the prerequisites?

You should be comfortable with Python (functions, classes, async/await, packaging), have shipped at least one backend project that exists outside of a tutorial, and be willing to write a lot of code. We assume you can debug a stack trace and read library source. We do **not** assume any prior ML, deep learning, or AI experience — the program teaches the AI engineering layer specifically, not the model-research layer.

Is the program in English or Bahasa Indonesia?

Lectures, materials, and code reviews are in English. Mentor sessions are bilingual — you can ask questions in either language. We made this choice because nearly all primary documentation (papers, library docs, model API references) is English-first.

Cohort Schedule

When does the next cohort start?

Cohort 14 starts on Monday, 22 September 2026 and graduates on Friday, 8 January 2027. Applications opened on 14 March 2026 and close on 30 July 2026 (or earlier if seats fill). We run two cohorts per year — Cohort 15 begins 23 February 2027.

How big is each cohort?

We cap each cohort at 32 students. This is intentional — it's the largest group our mentor team can give serious code-review attention to. Cohorts 11, 12, and 13 all ran at the cap.

What's the time commitment?

Plan for roughly 30 hours per week: two 4-hour in-person sessions (Tuesday and Friday evenings, 6pm–10pm WIB), one Saturday morning demo day, and the rest async work on your project. The program is designed to be combinable with a full-time job, but it's tight.

Tuition and Payment

How much does the program cost?

Tuition is **Rp 48,000,000** (forty-eight million rupiah) total for the 16-week AI Engineering track. The fee covers all materials, mentor access, hiring-partner introductions, and demo-day production. There are no additional fees for required software or services — we provide LLM API credits, vector DB access, and cloud compute throughout the program.

What payment options do you offer?

Three paths:

- 1. Full upfront:** Pay the full Rp 48M before week 1 and receive an 8% discount (net Rp 44.16M).
- 2. Four-payment plan:** Split into four equal installments of Rp 12M each, due before weeks 1, 5, 9, and 13. No interest, no fees.
- 3. Income Share Agreement (ISA):** Rp 4M deposit at enrollment, then pay 12% of your monthly salary for 18 months — but only after you're hired at Rp 8M/month or above. See the ISA section below for details.

Are scholarships available?

Yes. We award two kinds of scholarships every cohort:

Merit Scholarship — 50% off tuition. Eight seats per cohort. Awarded by panel review based on a take-home technical assignment plus a 30-minute interview. No financial-need requirement.

Diversity Scholarship — 100% off tuition. Four seats per cohort. For applicants from groups under-represented in Southeast Asian tech, including women, applicants from outside Jakarta/Bandung/Surabaya, and applicants over 35. Awarded by a separate panel.

The next scholarship deadline is **30 July 2026**, the same date as the general application close.

Income Share Agreement (ISA)

How exactly does the ISA work?

The ISA is a deferred-tuition agreement. You pay a **Rp 4,000,000** deposit at enrollment. After you graduate, you owe nothing until you're employed at a salary of **Rp 8,000,000 per month or higher**. Once you cross that threshold, you pay **12% of your gross monthly salary** for 18 calendar months. Payments pause automatically if your income drops below the floor.

Is the ISA capped?

Yes — total ISA payments are capped at **Rp 72,000,000** (1.5× the standard tuition). Once you've paid that total across the 18 months, the obligation ends regardless of your salary. The ISA also automatically expires 36 months after graduation if you've never crossed the income floor.

What counts toward 'salary' for the ISA?

Gross monthly base salary from full-time employment. Bonuses, equity, and freelance income do not count toward the 12% calculation. Self-employment income above Rp 12M/month counts at a flat 8% rate instead of 12%.

Can I switch payment paths after enrollment?

You can switch from the four-payment plan or ISA to full upfront at any time, but you cannot switch the other direction once the program has started. The 8% upfront discount is honored if you pay the remaining balance in full before week 8.

Hiring Outcomes and Partners

How many graduates get hired?

Cohort 13 placed 92% of graduates within 90 days of demo day, at an average starting salary of Rp 14.2M/month. The reported 8% includes graduates who chose to stay at their existing employer (often with a raise after the program) and one graduate who started their own company. We publish full outcome reports for every cohort on our website.

Who are your hiring partners?

We currently work with **47 hiring partners** across Southeast Asia. Anchor partners include Xendit, Halodoc, Ruangguru, Kopi Kenangan Digital, Tiket.com, Bibit, and Stockbit. We also place into Singapore-based and Y Combinator-backed startups — Cohort 13 alumni joined Glints, Vidio, AwanTunai, and three undisclosed YC W26 companies. The complete partner list is shared during the application interview.

Do you guarantee a job?

We do not guarantee employment — anyone who does is lying or selling something. What we do guarantee: (1) hiring partner introductions for every graduate who meets the demo-day bar, (2) unlimited 1:1 coaching with our career team for 12 months post-graduation, and (3) the ISA terms above, which structurally only ask you to pay if the program worked.

Refunds and Deferrals

What's the refund policy?

Within 7 days of cohort start: 100% refund, no questions asked, no paperwork.

Week 1 through end of week 4: Pro-rated refund based on weeks completed.

After week 4: No cash refunds, but you may defer your enrollment to a future cohort at no cost up to 12 months from your original start date. If you defer, the tuition you've already paid is held as credit toward the future cohort. ISA students who withdraw after week 4 owe only the Rp 4M deposit.

Can I take a break mid-cohort?

Yes — we call it a *pause*. You can pause once per cohort for up to four weeks (typically for medical reasons, bereavement, or unmissable work obligations). Pauses extend your graduation date by the same number of weeks. To pause twice or for longer than four weeks total, you'll need to formally defer to the next cohort.

What hardware do I need?

Any laptop made in the last five years with at least 16 GB of RAM is sufficient. We do all model inference through hosted APIs — there is no local GPU requirement. If you don't have a suitable laptop, our diversity scholarship covers loaner hardware for the duration of the program.

Application Process

How do I apply?

Three steps: (1) Fill out the online application at airanext.id/apply — about 20 minutes, covers your background, code samples, and goals. (2) Complete a short take-home assignment — a small RAG implementation, about 4–6 hours, you have one week. (3) A 45-minute interview with two members of our admissions team. We aim to send decisions within 10 business days of the interview.

What does the take-home assignment cover?

You'll build a tiny RAG system that ingests a small corpus, retrieves chunks for a query, and produces a grounded answer with citations. We provide a starter repo, the corpus, and a test query set. The grading rubric is published with the assignment — we score on correctness, code clarity, and how you handle edge cases (out-of-context queries, empty retrieval, etc.).

What if my application is rejected?

We send a written explanation with every rejection — usually it's about a specific skill gap we want closed before you join. You can re-apply for any future cohort at no cost; many of our strongest current students were rejected from an earlier cohort and re-applied after closing the gap we flagged.

Questions not answered here? Email admissions@airanext.id or join our weekly office hours every Thursday at 7pm WIB (link at airanext.id/office-hours).